GLIMPSE / ANDROID WALLPAPERS

Glimpse.

Something lovely, every time you look.

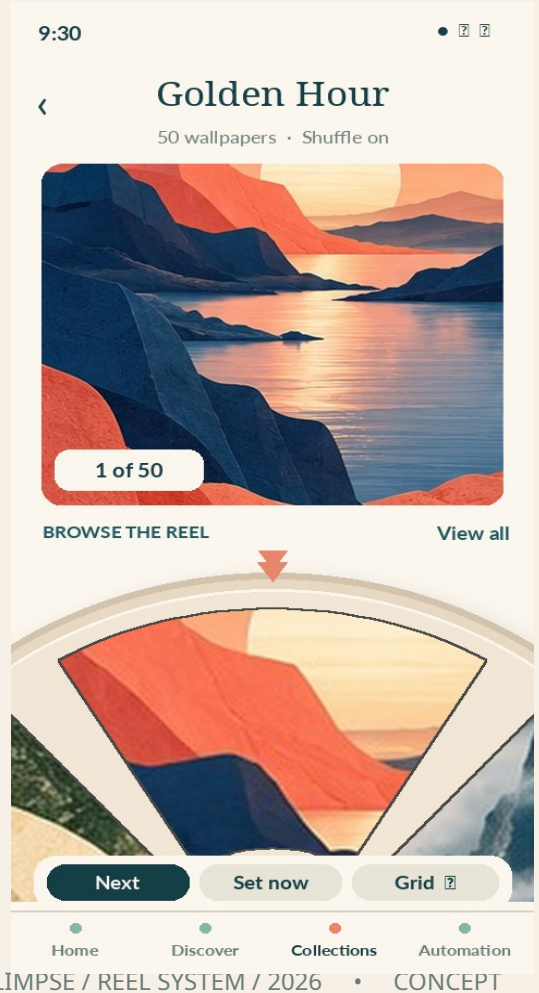
A native Android wallpaper app that makes your screen feel like a window into somewhere else.

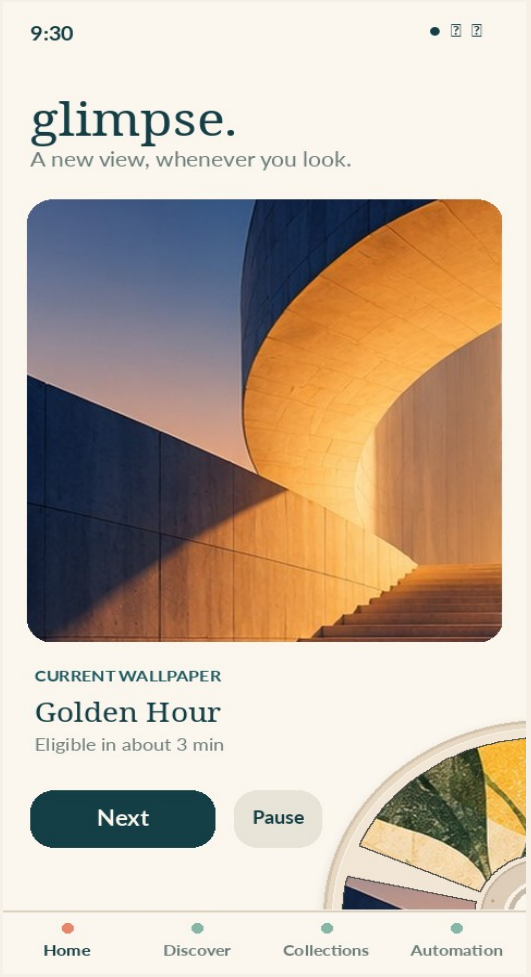


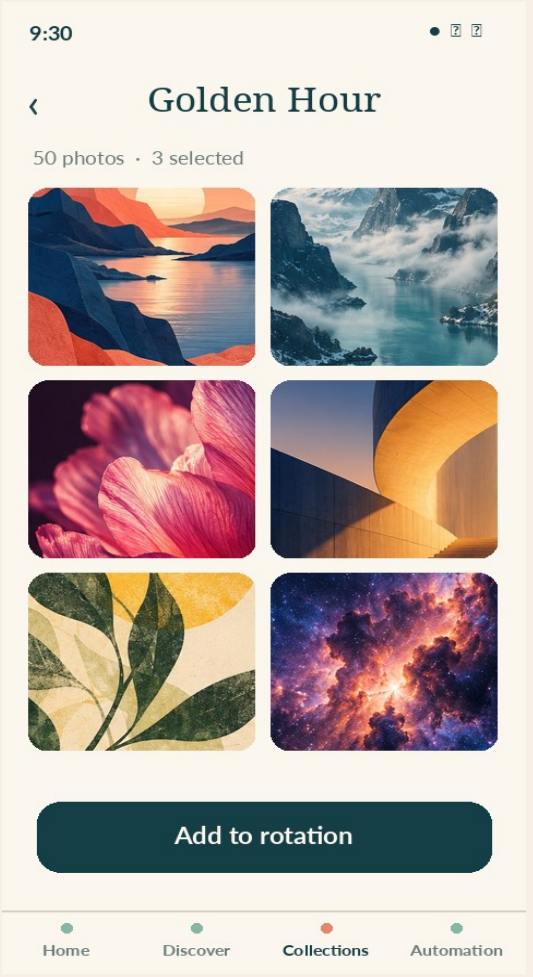
THE PAPER REEL / CONTINUOUS BROWSING / V4

A circle bigger than the screen.

The reel continues beyond the viewport. Only the active arc asks for attention.







01 BROWSE

Oversized reel extends beyond left, right and lower edges.

02 GLANCE

Home shows only a smaller crescent beside the current view.

03 ESCAPE

View all opens the ordinary image grid for serious library work.

A reel, freed from its old machinery.

Five generous photographic windows. Paper, light, movement, surprise.



THE OBJECT

The picture, not the perforation.

A larger opening makes the photograph legible, especially at small sizes. The circular paper shell is now a gentle framework for the imagery, not a historical constraint.

5 windows / 72° per step / pure visual metaphor

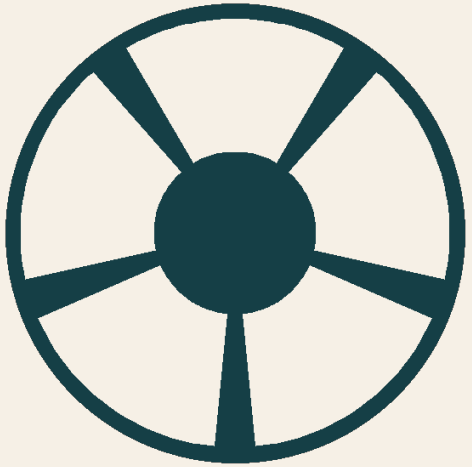
Three expressions of one object.

Different sizes and roles; the same paper, spindle and generous windows.



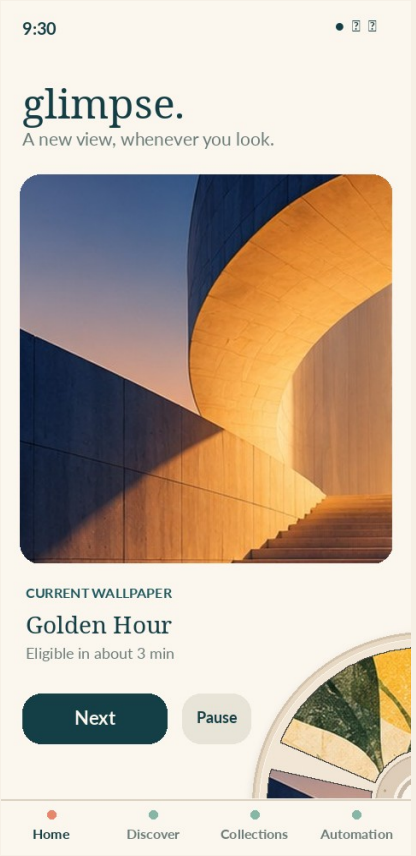
COLOUR REEL

Collection identity



MONOCHROME GLYPH

Android themed icon



IN CONTEXT

The windows move. The collection does not end at five.

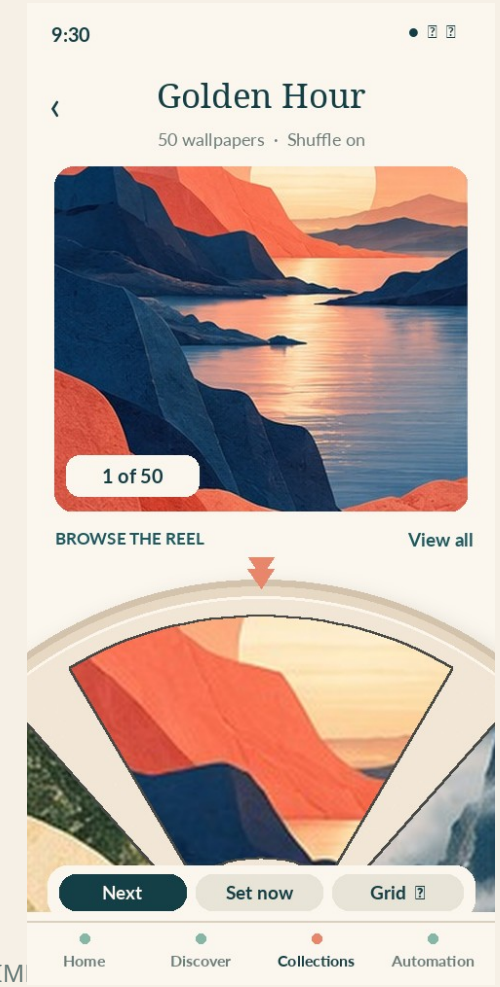
One fixed focal position; a few recycled windows; a stable, durable collection behind them.



A finite collection can wrap for browsing without implying an endless source. At a queue boundary, no-repeat shuffle reseeds explicitly and avoids immediate duplicates.

The preview stays still while the reel advances.

Touch and motion follow the user’s intent. Advancing the browser never silently changes the system wallpaper.



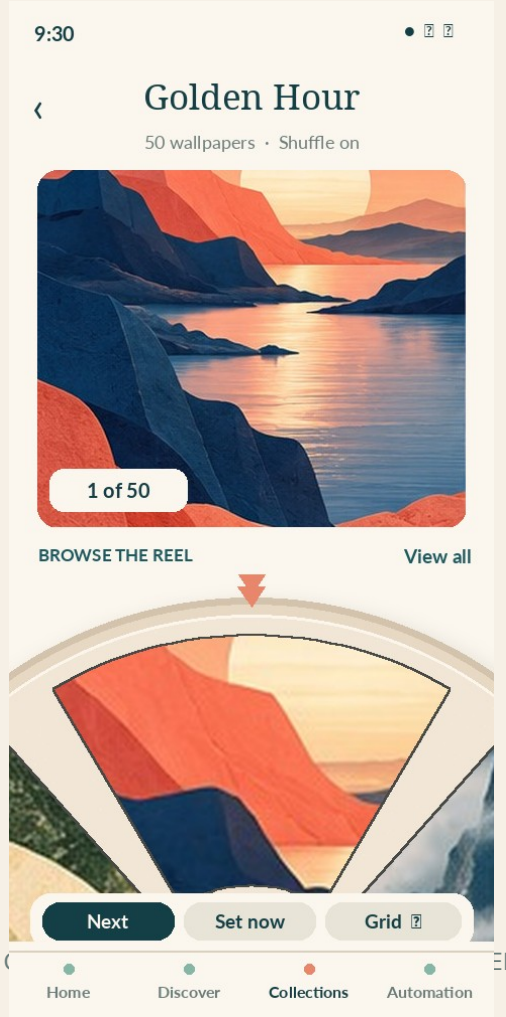


BROWSE **NEXT IMAGE**

Browse = choose what to view. Set now = deliberately apply. The image count follows actual collection membership.

The reel is a beautiful cover, not a storage format.

Each collection can show a distinctive crop of its own artwork.





Rainbows

240 photographs

Open collection



Wild Places

42 photographs

Open collection



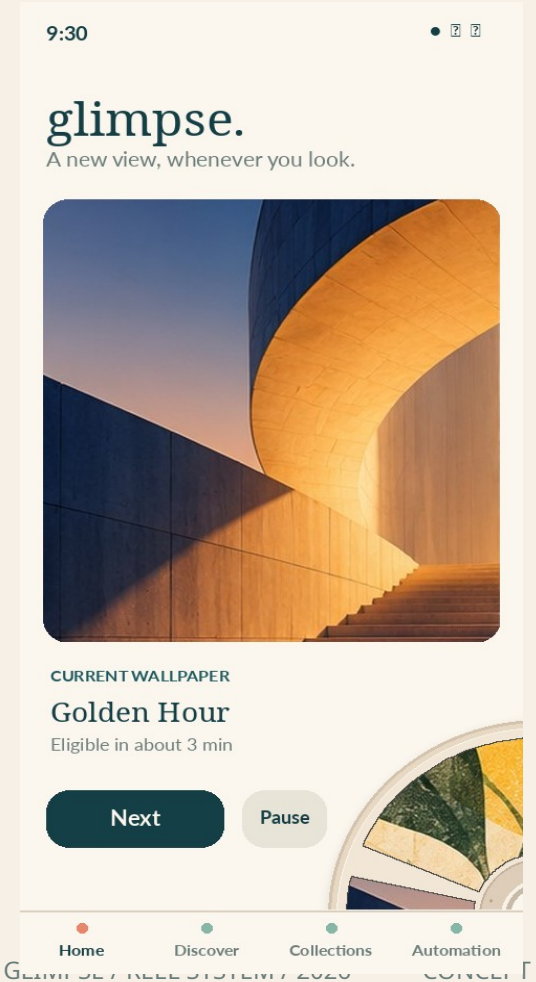
Golden Hour

50 photographs

Open collection

Let the wallpaper take the stage.

A small reel signature on Home, not a full spinning disk on every surface.



Current image first

The photograph takes the most space. Collection context stays nearby.

Immediate actions

Next, Pause, Share and Set now have ordinary labels and 48dp touch targets.

A little reel peeks in

A cropped crescent offers recognition and continuity, not an extra navigation burden.

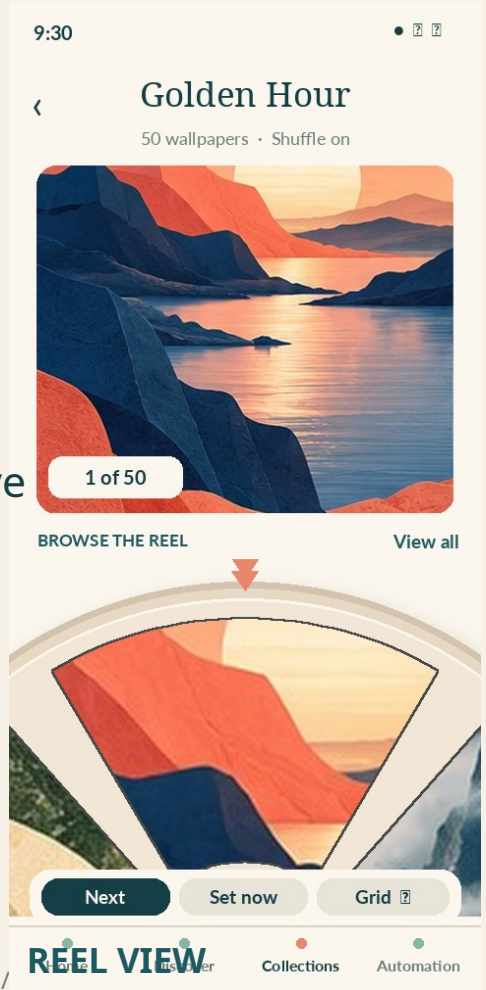
Scheduling stays honest

“Next eligible” refers to Android scheduling; it does not claim a guaranteed exact change.

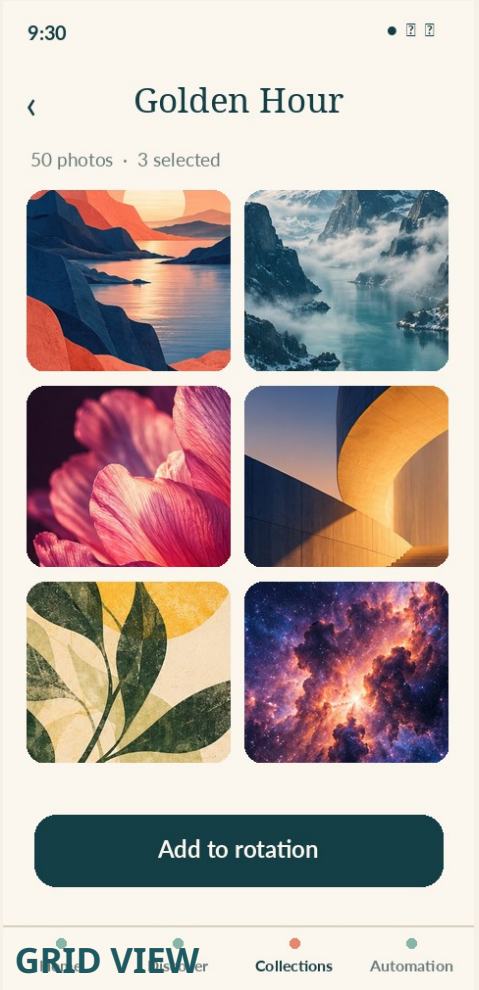
Delight to browse. Efficient to organize.

Two views for the same data. Switch instantly without losing selection or scroll position.

← Immersive inspection



REEL VIEW



GRID VIEW

Fast multi-select →

Poetry around the edges. Clarity in the controls.

Glimpse should feel warm without ever hiding what an action actually does.

WELCOME

Something lovely, every time you look.

BROWSE

Browse the reel · View all

ACTION

Next · Set as wallpaper · Share

STATE

50 wallpapers · Shuffle without repeats

DIAGNOSTICS

Next change eligible in about 3 min

ERROR

Couldn’t change wallpaper. Try now · Details

The illusion must never become an obstacle.

A carousel must remain a usable control when its shape, motion or gesture is unavailable.

Tap targets

Large Next / Previous buttons and a persistent View all option.

TalkBack

A linear list, labelled “Image 12 of 50”; actions in logical reading order.

Reduced motion

Instant image replacement, no reel turn or simulated inertia.

Large text

Text sits outside photographic windows; the reel can shrink or collapse.

Gesture conflict

Vertical scrolling scrolls the page; horizontal drag only in reel region.

No forced wrap

Finite “end of collection” mode or seamless browse loop; users can choose.

Responsive by design, not by shrinking the reel.

Clip to the reel's own container. Keep system bars, tap controls, and content accessibility independent.

SMALL PORTRAIT

Less visible arc

~60–70% of container width visible, with clear Next / Grid buttons.

360dp

LARGE PORTRAIT

Generous arc

More photograph and higher surrounding cards; no tiny windows.

412dp

LANDSCAPE / TABLET

Side-docked reel

Partial disk on the side, hero photograph and actions in the remaining pane.

> 600dp

A continuous reel is a viewport, not an infinite bitmap.

Reuse a handful of window nodes, keep position as a stable asset ID, and avoid unbounded list indexes.

Domain	collection IDs + deterministic order + shuffle queue + current index
Projection	current + 2 neighbours each side; recycled five-window snapshot
Gesture	pointer input → velocity threshold → one notch snap → selected ID
Rendering	Compose Canvas paths + clipped Coil image thumbnails at bounded resolution
Persistence	save image ID and browsing order; return after process death at same item
Testing	fuzz reorder/remove, empty/singleton sets, state restore, RTL, talkback

A little theatre. No deception.

The illusion represents movement through a collection, never a claim of endless new photographs.

End of collection

For Browse All, allow finite stop or opt-in wrap. For Shuffle, mark new cycle and avoid recent repeats.

Large collections

Never load every bitmap. Load neighbouring previews and keep random access through Grid and Search.

Active wallpaper

Browsing changes only the preview. “Set now” explicitly asks Android to apply the chosen asset.

Touch and motion

Reel steps are deliberate and short; no continuous spinning, auto-advance or audio by default.

Keep the tactile paper. Give the photographs room.

This is Glimpse’s signature interaction; everything else stays legible, native and easy.



THE DESIGN BET

A small window into somewhere else.

Icon: five large photographic windows.
Collection: reel as thumbnail cover.
Browser: oversized partial reel.
Home: restrained reel accent.
Grid: always one tap away.

The earlier research is retained.

The following slides capture the existing Glimpse product analysis, initial exploratory UI and the Android engineering plan. Some embedded mockup screenshots reflect the pre-reel design and are superseded by the new reel concepts.

Previous visual explorations

Useful interaction patterns remain; old image assets are evidence of the design process, not the chosen look.

Native architecture unchanged

Kotlin, Compose, Room, reliable wallpaper delivery, secure imports, universal sharing and signed APKs remain the implementation direction.